

Three big numbers, and every one lands before the bell

Inflation on Wednesday, producer prices on Thursday, retail sales on Friday. **All three print at 8:30 am eastern, an hour before the stock market opens.** The market that has to price them is at a record high with volatility at its lowest of the run.

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01 The week

Where the week starts, and what it is being asked to price. Surprises move markets, not the number itself.

3.4% Inflation expected	2.5% Core, expected	44% September hike odds	-23K July jobs, actual	14.90 VIX, into the week	7,757.64 S and P record close
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Where the scheduled risk sits. Times are eastern. The three that matter most all land at 8:30 am, an hour before the stock market opens.

MON 10 Nothing No US release at all CLEAR	TUE 11 10:00 Existing home sales SECOND TIER	WED 12 8:30 Inflation, the week's event THE DAY	THU 13 8:30 Producer prices, two Fed speakers PRE BELL	FRI 14 8:30 Retail sales, Michigan 10:00 PRE BELL
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Red top marks the week's main event. Green marks a morning with no release at all.

02 Wednesday

One release matters more than the rest of the calendar combined.

- Wednesday 8:30 am,** (CPI (the consumer price index: what a household basket of goods costs, compared with a year ago)). Consensus is **3.4 percent** against a year ago, with the core measure at **2.5 percent. Core strips out food and energy**, which swing on weather and war, so it reads cleaner on whether prices are genuinely settling.
- The Federal Reserve held rates in July with **three of twelve officials dissenting in favour of a rise.** Then the July jobs report showed the economy **lost 23,000 jobs**, and the odds of a September increase fell from about 67 percent to **44 percent.**

- A hot number puts the rise back on the table. A soft one confirms the market is right to have priced it out.

03 Thursday and Friday

Two more readings, each measuring a different point in the same chain.

- **Thursday 8:30 am**, (PPI (the producer price index: what companies pay for their own inputs)). One step upstream of shop prices, so it hints at what is coming rather than what has arrived. **Two Federal Reserve officials speak the same morning, both before the open, and one voted for a rise in July.**
- **Friday 8:30 am, retail sales.** Prices tell you what things cost. This tells you whether anyone is buying.
- **Friday 10:00 am, the Michigan survey.** Its inflation expectations component moves markets, because what people expect prices to do is itself an input into what prices do.

04 What just happened

The week being priced arrives after a straight line higher.

- **The S and P 500 closed at 7,757.64, its first record close in two months**, after the biggest four session run since April 2025. The Nasdaq 100 added **5.04 percent**.
- **Small companies joined in this time**, rising 3.56 percent against the S and P's 3.51. **Last week they were the only index falling.**
- Profits are the leg underneath it. Second quarter earnings are tracking near **48 percent growth** against 24 percent expected when the season began. **Reporting this week: CoreWeave, Cisco and Applied Materials.**

05 The catch

Three things this page will not claim.

- **Gold rose 8.66 percent last week, more than any stock index.** Shares rising says companies will earn more, gold rising says money will buy less, and **both cannot be the main story at once.**
- **Oil is the loose variable.** Crude fell 7.67 percent on reports Iran and Oman are close to a Strait of Hormuz shipping deal, then jumped three dollars when Iran signalled a ban on hostile vessels. **That headline can move over a weekend.**
- **The dealer positioning read is unavailable for the second week running.** The note carrying it was not published. **Blank beats guessed.**

THE ONE LINE

A record high market with cheap volatility has to price three inflation and spending numbers, and every one of them lands before the opening bell.

SOURCES & NOTE

Sources: Release dates and times: tradingeconomics.com calendar, live lookup August 9 2026 (page renders UTC, converted at eastern equals UTC minus 4, offset proved against three permanently fixed slots), cross checked against the OMB federal release schedule for 2026; Inflation consensus, rate odds and earnings pace: Reuters via Yahoo Finance week ahead, August 7 2026; Levels: Yahoo Finance daily bars at the August 7 settle. Hormuz: CNBC and Business Recorder, August 6 2026.

Educational, not financial advice. A record of what happened and what is scheduled, for Mann's own discretion.

Glossary

CPI The consumer price index. What a household basket costs against a year ago.

Core The same basket with food and energy removed, because those two swing on weather and war.

PPI The producer price index. What companies pay for their inputs, one step upstream of shop prices.

Consensus What economists on average expect. Price moves on the gap to this, not on the number.

Dissent A Federal Reserve official voting against the decision. Three did so in July.

Inflation expectations What people think prices will do. It feeds back into what prices actually do.

Dealer positioning How options market makers are hedged. It shapes whether moves get damped or amplified.
